



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

SEPT 2020



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Minnehaha
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About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

Minnehaha Children, Youth, & Family Ministries

This fall, we continue to seek ways to support one another, to serve our community, and to celebrate together with gratitude.

We offer spaces for people to connect, to experience & offer grace, to replenish, and to do the work of justice, kindness, and love.

Young Families

Young families are invited to join us as they are able at our monthly in-person gatherings. Children's Council is working to connect neighborhood groups together for support and encouragement.

Preschoolers & Kindergartners

Preschoolers and Kindergartners will be using *The Beautitudes* curriculum to explore how the world might look when we work for justice and peace for everyone. A lesson will be shared each week for families to do on their own time, in addition to a Sunday morning opportunity to gather together. We also are planning a preschool and kindergartner parent group that will meet via zoom, and hope families join us for monthly events.

Elementary Students

Elementary students will be also be using *The Beautitudes* curriculum to explore how the world might look when we work for justice and peace for everyone. A lesson will be shared each week for families to do on their own time, in addition to a Sunday morning opportunity to gather together. We will also be gathering Wednesdays for music opportunities, and hope families will join us for Monthly Events.

Middle & High Schoolers

We'll be offering opportunities to gather online and, safely-distanced, in-person for our youth. From Sunday morning check-ins to bike rides, cooking to drama, grade level conversation groups, crafting, gaming and more, we seek to provide a safe place for our teens to connect with peers, with trusted adults, and with their faith.

We'll celebrate confirmation for tenth graders on September 27th, and on September 16th our new class of confirmands will begin their studies.

Sunday Mornings

Worship will continue to be shared online via our social media platforms, with outdoor worship continuing through September. SEPTEMBER 27th we will be celebrating CONFIRMATION SUNDAY.

Starting September 20th, there will be online Faith Formation at 10:30am. This will be supplemented by recorded videos and at-home activities.

Links to online faith formation opportunities are sent out through private emails. If you are interested in attending, please email education@minnehaha.org.

Wednesday Evenings

Wednesday evenings will offer a variety of short-term opportunities to allow us to respond to the changing needs (based on both the Covid Pandemic and Minnesota weather).

Our first session for elementary children, youth, and their families (parents are requested to stay), is Taiko Drumming – outside in the Minnehaha lawn. We'll be creating Taiko drums and learning to play them.

Session Runs: Wednesdays Sept. 16th–Oct 7th from 6–7pm. With a final session on Saturday, Oct. 10th at noon. Registration Required.

Monthly Events

Beyond our regularly scheduled events, as possible we will be doing an in-person event at least once each month for our children, youth, and families.

These events are designed to be mindful of safety – and are offered outside with space for social-distancing and masks required.

September 13th:

Family Fun Day for Children & their Families from 10:30am–noon.
Fall Bike Ride for Youth
1–3pm

October 10th:

Keep the Campfires Glowing
Fundraiser & Fun Activities to support the Minnesota Conference
Camps

Worship in September

This fall, we continue our walk with the Hebrew people – into the wilderness. We cross the Red Sea on Sept. 13, and then commence with some wandering, some community-building, and some creating of new relationships with God. As we look at our changing world, it seems like a good metaphor. To aid us in our wandering, we are going to also hear from a variety of people about the things they do and how those things are informed by their faith.

Sept. 13, 2020

“Crossing into the Wilderness”

Exodus 14:19-31

Sept. 20, 2020

“Faith in Action: Meredith Webb and Anti-Racism”

Jeremiah 29:1, 4-5, 7

Sept. 27, 2020

“Faith in Action: Jason Emrick & Ashley Smit and Working with Youth”

Recognition of our 10th graders who have finished the confirmation program:

Cooper Cronquist, Carter Eichten, Ava Erickson, Paige Gruenhagen, Libby Kramer, Jaden Terwey

Oct. 4, 2020

“When You Are the Subject of Jesus’ Parable”

Matthew 21:33-46



Savannah Thayer, daughter of Taylor Wood, was baptized on August 30th



MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us on Sept. 27. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, and bring a friend (and a mask)!



Family Fun Day

Volunteers Needed:

The Nokomis East Neighborhood Association (NENA) launched a pilot program to bring food directly to the residents of Bossen Housing this July. Since the start of the program, over 700 households have been served. Residents come out every 2nd and 4th Wed of the month to pick up groceries such as milk, produce, canned goods, and household cleaning supplies. NENA is inviting everyone and anyone to come to participate as a volunteer to help distribute foods, help with set-up, or takedown. There is a job for anyone who wishes to help. We ask those who are considered vulnerable populations to stay home. If you are interested in volunteering and or would like to share it to others to sign up and volunteer please use the link below

Volunteers Needed: <https://www.signupgenius.com/go/4090c45afa923abf85-bossen1>

Help with Sound & Camera

We are looking for a few adults and youth who are willing to help out with our sound system and our livestreaming cameras. While we move back to only online worship, those opportunities will not necessarily be on Sunday mornings, but might be for helping out with an outdoor baptism or recording a Taize service or recording a small group of musicians providing music for a worship service. Jefferson Slinkard is our sound coordinator and Jim Bohl is our livestreaming coordinator, and both are happy to train you in on our equipment (which has gotten simpler and more computerized in the last few months). Please contact either of them or Becky Sechrist if you are interested in learning more. Thank you!!



Confirmation for Adults

What do you remember from your confirmation class? All I remember is that I went, and we had a retreat one weekend and watched a film that had a narrator with really big ears. That's about it. Oh, and the friends I made in confirmation class.

In case you would like a refresher (or, for some of us, a more updated experience), this year on Sundays at 10:30 -11:30, I (Becky) am offering Confirmation for Adults! We will be utilizing the same lesson topics as what the 9th graders are covering each week, but without the silly games (actually, since they are probably doing the whole year online, they may go without the silly games as well). The classes are geared for a combination of content and discussion. Each week you get an email inviting you to the link for watching worship, the link for coffee hour, and there will now be a new link, for this class. The link is the same each week, so if you suddenly misplace your Sunday email, you can just use the one from the week before. The class begins on Sept. 20. Although the class does build on some knowledge from week to week, you can certainly miss classes without getting too lost, and you can join a few weeks late as well.

If you are not getting the enews (usually sent on Monday with news and Sunday with links to worship and classes), please contact Heather at the office (office@minnehaha.org) and ask to be added to our enews email list.



Taizé Online

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. Our Taizé team created distantly-recorded services that are available on our website and our YouTube channel. They are working on creating a service for September that will be recorded in the sanctuary. Watch the enews for when it becomes available. Their goal is to create a new service each month that you can watch



Recordings of Scripture Readers and Acolytes Needed

As we move back exclusively online in October, we are looking for a variety of faces and voices in our worship service. If you are willing to video record yourself reading the scripture lesson or lighting our candle, please contact either Jenia Strom or Becky Sechrist. We can give you the parameters for your recording (hold your phone sideways, how long the recording should be, etc.), and give you the link for uploading your video. All recordings need to be done at least by Thursday for the coming Sunday, but can be recorded much further in advance of that if you want!



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9/20



Socially distanced church

Minnehaha Children, Youth, & Family Ministries

Young Family Ministries - for infant & toddlers

Minnehaha Kids - for preschoolers through fifth graders

Youth Group - for sixth through twelfth graders

with many family & intergenerational opportunities

Register online for the program
year at www.minnehaha.org

Join our age-specific mailing lists
& Social Media groups
by contacting Jenia Strom,
Dir. of CYF Ministries at
education@minnehaha.org

